

PROFESSIONAL SERVICES SPECIALISTS

As stated previously, attorneys play a pivotal role in the transfer of wealth between generations. Accountants are also important in this regard. These professionals often serve as key advisors to the affluent. Advice in this context extends beyond the normal core of accounting and legal services. These professionals are relied on for their insights into how best to distribute substantial financial and other gifts to children and grandchildren. Clients often view these accountants as their first line of defense against paying substantial gift and estate taxes. They are often called upon to be co-executors of the estates of their affluent clients. It is not unusual for co-executors in these situations to receive a percentage of the estates of their clients. This is one way the affluent reward these trusted advisors for a lifetime of sage advice. Specialists who will benefit include:

♦ **Accountants** providing tax-planning strategies; estate, trust, and gift tax solutions; fiduciary services; business/asset valuation; and retirement planning

HOUSING SPECIALISTS/DWELLING PRODUCTS/SERVICES

More than half the affluent population will provide their offspring with financial assistance in purchasing a home. This figure actually understates the incidence of such outpatient care because often other substantial financial gifts not earmarked for specific use are used for home purchases and related expenses. Those who receive “home-acquisition subsidies” from their relatives are often less sensitive to the variations in home prices than the nonsubsidized. (As always, our data suggest that it is easier to spend other people’s money.) This trend should benefit many of those who are employed in the residential housing and mortgage-lending businesses.

Home-acquisition subsidies typically do not negate the need for credit. Actually, parents who provide part of the purchase price of a home often precipitate the purchase of more expensive homes and larger mortgages on the part of their sons and daughters. Specialists who will benefit include: